SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #79 · DEATH & GRIEF

“My loved one who died by suicide can never be with God.”

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Where it often comes from

Teaching that suicide is an unforgivable sin. Fear that because there was no chance to repent, salvation was lost. Painful comments from others after the loss. Deep grief mixed with confusion, anger, and guilt. Not knowing what Scripture actually says.

What Scripture teaches

Suicide is a deep tragedy, and grief after it is especially heavy. But Scripture does not name it as an unforgivable sin. A believer’s salvation rests on Christ’s finished work, not on a final act or final confession. Nothing in all creation can separate those in Christ from the love of God. Many who die by suicide are suffering from illness and overwhelming pain. We cannot see a person’s heart, but we can trust the Judge of all the earth, who is just and full of mercy.

> *“For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord”* **(Romans 8:38–39)**.

Also see

> “I give them eternal life, and they will never perish. No one can snatch them out of My hand. My Father who has given them to Me is greater than all. No one can snatch them out of My Father’s hand” **(John 10:28–29)**.

> “Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?” **(Genesis 18:25)**.

> “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit” **(Psalm 34:18)**.

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” **(Psalm 147:3)**.

Common self-statements

- They can’t be in heaven because of how they died.
- Suicide is the one sin God won’t forgive.
- They didn’t have time to repent, so they’re lost.
- I’ll never see them again.
- I should have stopped them.
- God rejected them in their worst moment.

Common logical errors

- **Overgeneralization:** Treating one act as the whole story of a person’s relationship with God.
- **Mind reading:** Assuming you know your loved one’s final standing with God.
- **Personalization:** Blaming yourself for another person’s choice in unbearable pain.

- **Accepting teaching without checking:** Believing suicide is unforgivable without biblical basis.

Challenging questions

- Does Scripture call suicide an unforgivable sin?
- Does salvation rest on a final confession or on Christ's work?
- What does Romans 8:38–39 say can separate believers from God's love?
- Could illness and pain have played a part in what happened?
- Do I know everything that was in my loved one's heart?
- Can I trust the Judge of all the earth to be just and merciful?
- Am I carrying blame that is not mine to carry?

Truth summary

> Suicide is a tragedy, but Scripture does not teach that it is unforgivable. Salvation rests on Christ's finished work, and nothing in all creation can separate those in Christ from God's love. I cannot see my loved one's heart, but I can trust a just and merciful God with them. I do not have to carry blame for their choice.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Grief
- Death/Dying
- Salvation
- Guilt/Shame
- Mercy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My loved one who died by suicide can never be with God"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My loved one who died by suicide can never be with God." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Does Scripture call suicide unforgivable?
- ☐ Does salvation rest on a final confession?
- ☐ What can separate believers from God's love?
- ☐ Could illness and pain have played a part?
- ☐ Can I trust God to be just and merciful?
- ☐ Am I carrying blame that isn't mine?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Scripture does not call suicide unforgivable.
- ☐ Salvation rests on Christ, not on a final act.
- ☐ Nothing can separate those in Christ from God's love.
- ☐ I can trust a just and merciful God with my loved one.
- ☐ I do not have to carry blame for their choice.
- ☐ God is near to me in my broken heart.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- [ ] **John 10:28–29**
  "I give them eternal life, and they will never perish. No one can snatch them out of My hand. My Father who has given them to Me is greater than all. No one can snatch them out of My Father's hand."
- [ ] **Genesis 18:25**
  "Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?"
- [ ] **Psalm 34:18**
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- [ ] **Psalm 147:3**
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Grief journal:** Each day, write one memory of my loved one and one truth that gives me hope.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 34:18 becomes: "The LORD is near to **Sarah** when **she** is brokenhearted; He saves **her** when **she** is contrite in spirit."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Grief" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Find a suicide-loss support group** or a grief counselor who understands this kind of loss.
- ☐ **Write a letter to God** about your grief, anger, and questions.
- ☐ **Read Romans 8:31–39 aloud,** and underline every word about God's love.
- ☐ **If you are struggling with thoughts of ending your own life,** call or text 988 (in the U.S.) or reach out to someone right away.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My loved one who died by suicide can never be with God": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One step of care for myself
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My loved one who died by suicide can never be with God.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, my heart is broken by this loss. Help me reject the belief that my loved one can never be with You because of how they died. I trust them to Your justice and mercy. Free me from blame that is not mine, and stay near to me in my grief. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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